TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain a Rule and the Reason Behind It

Explain | OREO | Rule Briefing

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Explain a rule to a new colleague: what it is, why it exists and when there is an exception, and answer their concern politely.

WHO	You work in the office of a small company in Johor Bahru. Ali joined last week and sits next to you. He is the only IT person for all 25 staff.
SITUATION	It is Wednesday. Ali wants this Friday off for his cousin's wedding in Muar, but Siti in HR said no. He is unhappy: 'Why? It's only one day!' He asks you to explain.
NEED	The rule: apply for annual leave in the app at least 3 working days before. Why: Mr. Tan must find cover, and the outside IT company needs 3 days' notice. Exception: an emergency, like a sick child. Then call Siti before 9 a.m.
GOAL	Explain the rule, why it exists and when there is an exception, so that Ali understands. Then answer his concern politely.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Ali asks: "Siti says I can't take leave this Friday. Why not? It's only one day!" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Ali, I understand. It's only one day. But the rule here is that you have to apply for annual leave in the app at least three working days before. This is because the outside IT company that covers your work needs three days' notice, so we can't book them for this Friday. For example, we have 25 staff and only one IT person: you. If the internet stops on Friday and nobody can fix it, 25 people can't work. So normal leave is always three days before. But if it's an emergency, like a sick child, you just call Siti before 9 a.m. Is that clear?

O THE RULE _____

R REASON _____

E EXAMPLE _____

O RULE AGAIN + EXCEPTION _____

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar explains a rule to a customer. Put it in order: Rule → Reason → Example → Rule again + exception.

- ☐ For example, if you order 40 grey chairs for RM6,000 and then cancel, we can't sell them to anyone else.
- ☐ This is because we buy the stock only for you, so we can't send it back to the factory.
- ☐ For orders over RM1,000, we ask for a 30% deposit before we order the stock.
- ☐ So the deposit is always 30%. But if you're a school, you can pay after delivery.

Write the letter: **O** = The rule · **R** = Reason · **E** = Example · **O** = Rule again + exception

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY THE RULE

- [ ] The rule here is that …
- [ ] Everyone has to …
- [ ] You can't …

GIVE THE REASON

- [ ] This is because …
- [ ] The reason is that …
- [ ] So …
- [ ] For example, …

SAY THE EXCEPTION

- [ ] But if …, you can …
- [ ] The only exception is …
- [ ] You don't have to … if …

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Does that make sense?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] I understand, but …
- [ ] I know it's only …, but …
- [ ] That's true. That's why …
- [ ] Good question. If …, you can …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. We have this rule. [for example, / so / because] It takes time to find cover for your work.

2. The IT company needs three days' notice. [so / because / if] We can't book them for this Friday.

3. Normal leave needs three days' notice. [for example, / but / so] Emergency leave doesn't.

4. It's an emergency. [because / If … / For example,] Call Siti before 9 a.m.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. You _____ apply in the app at least three working days before. (The rule)
   - ○ has to
   - ○ having to
   - ○ have to
2. Mr. Tan _____ time to find cover. (A fact about now)
   - ○ needs
   - ○ needing
   - ○ need
3. In an emergency, you _____ wait three days. (The exception)
   - ○ not have to
   - ○ don't have to
   - ○ doesn't have to
4. If your child _____ sick in the morning, call Siti before 9 a.m. (A condition)
   - ○ are
   - ○ being
   - ○ is

SLIDE 09 have to · don't have to · basic if

A rule is about now: what everyone has to do, what you don't have to do in the exception, and what to do if something happens.

You **have to** apply three working days before.

The IT company **needs** three days' notice.

In an emergency, you **don't have to** wait.

If your child **is** sick, **call** Siti before 9 a.m.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O THE RULE

I understand. But the rule here is that you have to …

R REASON

This is because … So …

E EXAMPLE

For example, …

O RULE AGAIN + EXCEPTION

So … But if …, you can … Is that clear?

SLIDE 11

Rule Briefing

The speaker explains a rule, why it exists and its exception. The listener cannot see the card, writes the note, decides three cases (yes or no) and raises one concern.

1. Round 1 (3:00): say your card number. Explain the rule, why, an example, the exception. The listener writes the note.
2. Listener: ask if a line is empty. Say yes or no for each case, and why; then one concern. Speaker: answer it.
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Same card, new listener, shorter: the rule, why, the exception.
4. Round 3 (1:00): new listener, workbook and card turned over. Then swap: explain a rule from your own work.

Card 1 · Parking at the office

Card 2 · Travel claims

Card 3 · Shift swaps in the showroom

Card 4 · Company laptops

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
The rule			
Why + one example			
The exception			
Cases 1 2 3 · concern ✓			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Ali asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. But it's only one day! Why do I need to ask three days before?
2. Nobody told me about this rule. That's not fair.
3. What if my mother goes to hospital in the night? I can't plan that!

Start with: **I understand, but … · That's true. That's why … · Good question. If …, you can …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend visits you at your condo. He is unhappy: the guard wants to see his IC and write down his car number. Explain the rule, why the condo has it, and when it is different (for example, when he comes in your car).

The rule here is that … · This is because … · For example, … · But if …, …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] States the rule and gives one reason for it, with an example.
- [ ] Says when there is an exception.
- [ ] Acknowledges the listener's concern and answers it in one or two sentences.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Rule and reason	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
The exception	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering a concern	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Parking at the office

You are new. Note the rule, why and the exception. Then yes or no: 1) Stop in front with a new printer for the office? 2) Park in front all morning when it rains? 3) Park in front at 7.30 a.m.?

Card 2 · Travel claims

You are new. Note the rule, why and the exception. Then yes or no: 1) It is the 27th. Claim and get the money this month? 2) Claim with no receipt? 3) You are in Penang on the 25th. Claim on time?

Card 3 · Shift swaps in the showroom

You are new. Note the rule, why and the exception. Then yes or no: 1) On Monday, swap next Sunday's shift? 2) On Friday night, swap your Saturday shift? 3) You wake up with a fever. Miss your shift?

Card 4 · Company laptops

You are new. Note the rule, why and the exception. Then yes or no: 1) Take a laptop to a customer: sign? 2) Work from home every Friday: sign every week? 3) Take one home tonight, sign tomorrow?

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Parking at the office

About 40 customers a day come to collect orders · If you carry something heavy, you can stop in front for 10 minutes · Staff park at the back, not in front · The 6 parking spaces in front are for customers

Card 2 · Travel claims

On a work trip on the 25th? WhatsApp Mei Ling a photo of the receipt · She pays claims with the salary at the end of the month · Hand in claims with the receipt by the 25th · 60 claims a month: 3 days to check

Card 3 · Shift swaps in the showroom

Sick on the day? Call Siti before your shift; send a photo of your MC that day · Every shift needs 2 cashiers · Siti needs time to change the roster · Swap a shift: tell Siti at least 2 days before · Saturday: about 300 customers

Card 4 · Company laptops

Ali checks the list every Friday · Working from home every Friday? Sign once a month · Every laptop has customer data on it · Taking a laptop out of the office? Sign the laptop list first · The company has 15 laptops